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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Equatorial Guinea has no completed national digital economy strategy: eight World Bank specialists opened a four-day working week in Malabo on 2 September 2026 with the Minister of State Honorato Evita Oma, ORTEL, GITGE and CNIAPGE to finish and validate the Estrategia Nacional de Economía Digital, complete the sector's legal and regulatory framework, and prepare what would be the Bank's first operation in the country in 35 years.

The state's named digital agenda is ADIGE, 33 action lines running 2019–2025 and framed against the UN 2030 Agenda, the CPLP Digital Agenda and the African Union's Agenda 2063. It carries a roadmap for coverage, ICT training and digitalisation incentives but no implementation roadmap for data exchange or interoperability, and no national strategy for digital public platforms has been adopted. The country is also the only CEMAC member state without a national financial inclusion strategy.

Ley Número 9/2025 of 9 December 2025, the FY2026 budget, allocates CFA 5,802,246,000 to the transport, telecommunications and artificial-intelligence section, 23% less than in FY2025. The ministry's second extraordinary directive council adopted a July–December 2026 plan of 35 strategic objectives under three national priorities, one of them restoring sovereignty over the national digital space including the .GQ domain; the plan passes to the interministerial council and then the Council of Ministers, which decide which measures are recorded and funded, so as at 31 July 2026 the objectives are adopted and not financed.

The long-run frame is Decreto 69/2021 of 29 April 2021, which adopts the Estrategia Nacional de Desarrollo Sostenible "Agenda Guinea Ecuatorial 2035" and creates the Consejo Nacional de Desarrollo Sostenible, CONAP, the Agencia Nacional de Desarrollo and the Observatorio Guinea Ecuatorial 2035. A draft decree creating a Digital Exclusive Economic Zone at Djibloho was taken at a directive council in March 2026, with no perimeter, incentive schedule or commencement date.

Legislation and regulation

Equatorial Guinea's telecommunications sector still runs on Ley 7/2005, and in June 2025 the ministry opened an international tender for a specialist firm to lead an integral reform of it covering artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, data protection and satellite services. The World Bank found the legal framework for the digital economy outdated, with some provisions still resting on colonial-era law from 1965 and laws on data interoperability and sharing and on e-commerce absent or out of date (2024).

The one modern digital statute in force is Ley Núm. 7/2024 of 23 December 2024, regulating social-network use, computer crime and cybercrime, which defines 42 terms and carries 40 numbered offences in Título III — identity usurpation at three to eight years' imprisonment and fines of 1,000,000 to 50,000,000 CFA francs, alongside

offences for child sexual exploitation material, cyberbullying and ICT sexual harassment. Its article 21 creates the Agencia Nacional de Ciberseguridad e Infraestructuras Críticas as an autonomous body under the Presidencia del Gobierno with administrative sanctions of 50,000 to 20,000,000 CFA francs, and articles 56 to 64 provide data-preservation orders of up to 90 days, search and seizure of computer systems, extradition and mutual legal assistance.

Payment services are not governed nationally at all: CEMAC Règlement n°04/18 of 21 December 2018, in force since 1 January 2019, applies directly without domestic transposition. Electronic signature has been recognised since Ley 2/2017 of 10 January 2017, and the most recent telecoms instrument is ORTEL's Orden Ministerial 1/2026 of 13 February 2026 on the broadband-capacity access market.

Much else sits at bill stage: a land cadastre bill approved by the Chamber of Deputies on 7 May 2025, a 97-article public-sector contracts bill that would establish an electronic procurement information system, opened in the Senate on 3 November 2025, an anteproyecto reforming the 1957 Civil Registry Law taken by the interministerial council on 19 November 2025, and a draft decree recodifying the tax identification number taken on 10 August 2026.

Data protection

The Órgano Rector de Protección de Datos Personales, the supervisory authority created by Ley 1/2016, was still not operational in 2022, and the Technical Secretariat and the General Data Protection Registry that the statute places beneath it hang on the same implementing decree. Article 15 of the statute defers the body's composition and powers to a subsequent decree.

Ley Núm. 1/2016 of 22 July 2016 is the founding statute, granting data subjects rights of access, rectification, cancellation, opposition and indemnisation and setting a three-tier leve/grave/muy grave sanctions regime with fines reaching CFA 15,000,000. Its article 21 allows public administration bodies to share personal data only for historical, statistical or scientific purposes and requires private holders to obtain a court order before disclosing it, and no data-localisation or residency requirement applies.

The enforcement that exists is criminal. Article 44 of Ley 7/2024 penalises unauthorised use of personal data that violates confidentiality or security systems at four to six years' imprisonment and 1,000,000 to 10,000,000 F CFA, and article 46 penalises disseminating private information without the holder's consent at three to six years, rising where it is done for profit. Article 7(c) obliges platform providers and administrators to establish technical blocking mechanisms, with a judicially ordered right of retraction under article 8.

Two personal-data regimes are in force at once: a 2016 civil-administrative statute whose named regulator has never been constituted, and a 2024 criminal statute enforced through the courts and a newly created cybersecurity agency rather than through any data-protection authority.

Sectoral duties come from the monetary union. Titre 6 of CEMAC Règlement n°01/20 binds banking and payment establishments to lawful collection, confidentiality and security of personal data, and its articles 30 and 31 give customers a right to be told the purpose of any transfer of their data to third parties, to consent to it in advance, and to have their data rectified or erased. Ratification of the Malabo Convention, approved by the Chamber of Deputies in March 2026, would require the country to create a competent data-protection authority and supervision mechanisms.

Regional collaboration

The Chamber of Deputies approved ratification of the African Union's Malabo Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection on 25 March 2026, by unanimity of both parliamentary groups and on the report of the parliamentary foreign policy and treaties committee, paired in the same sitting with the Convention establishing the International Organization for Mediation; Foreign Minister Simeón Oyono Esono Angue presented it as a framework harmonising African digital legislation and requiring competent data-protection authorities. Two years earlier Ley 7/2024 had already named the Convention, with the 2001 Budapest Convention, as its model. The vote authorised ratification before the country had signed: Equatorial Guinea signed the Convention at Addis Ababa on 28 July 2026, and no instrument of ratification is on record, so it is not yet a party.

The regional instrument that would bind most directly is not adopted. A 2025–2030 regional digital-trade policy and a framework law harmonising data-protection and cybersecurity rules and providing for free movement of data were drafted at an ECA/ECCAS workshop at Douala on 24 September 2025, and the texts remain pending endorsement by ECCAS's Specialized Technical Committees and then by the Conference of Heads of State.

Monetary-union law binds without that step. CEMAC Règlement n°01/20 of 3 July 2020, in force from 1 January 2021, places banks, microfinance institutions and payment service providers under fair-treatment, transparency and complaint-handling duties, and its article 52 obliges Equatorial Guinea as a member state to put in place a legal framework for personal-data protection. Mobility runs on the same basis: the CEMAC additional act of 1 April 2019 exempts nationals of the six states from visas for stays of up to 90 days on presentation of a biometric identity card or passport.

Bilaterally, Equatorial Guinea and Gabon launched Roaming Cero CEMAC on 18 November 2025, removing additional roaming charges between the two countries; extending it to Cameroon, Chad and the Central African Republic is an objective of the ministry's July–December 2026 plan rather than an agreement. A digital-transformation agreement with Nigeria was signed in February 2026 with both foreign ministers present, and INEGE's director-general spoke for the African Group at the 57th UN Statistical Commission in March 2026, pressing for consolidated civil-registration and vital-statistics systems.

Standards

The binding technical standards reaching Equatorial Guinea's payment system are set regionally. BEAC Governor's Instruction N°001/GR/2025 of 17 November 2025 makes ISO 20022 mandatory across CEMAC payment systems, binding participants in Equatorial Guinea to CBPR+/SWIFT rules for international flows and BEAC-specific formats for the SYGMA and SYSTAC2 systems on a migration timetable running from November 2025 to May 2026, and a companion circular opened access to the closed CEMAC-BANK community on SWIFT's MyStandard portal where those specifications are published. A community interoperable QR-code standard was adopted by the UMAC Ministerial Committee at N'Djamena on 8 April 2026. Under the payment-services regulation, rulemaking and technical-standards power sits with BEAC and supervision with COBAC, not with a national regulator.

A national standards body is still to be built: the interministerial council took a draft decree creating a standardisation agency on 10 February 2025, and the agency, AGENOR, presented a seven-stage plan in March 2025 while still pre-launch. Nationally, the regulator confirms two standards instruments in force by title and date: OM Núm. 4/2018 of 22 August 2018 on integral quality of service in electronic communications, and OM Núm. 4/2020 of 3 December 2020 on ORTEL's own inspection, sanctioning and revenue-collection powers. The statutory vocabulary for the field comes from Ley 7/2024, which defines 42 terms from ciberdelincuencia to ciberterrorismo. In August 2026 the government adopted a national quality-assurance framework for official statistics, a standard protocol for the collection, processing and dissemination of socio-economic data.

Cross-border radio interference with Gabon was declared resolved in November 2025 after ORTEL and Gabon's ARCEP completed spectrum-management and frequency-assignment procedures for the border zones. Equatorial Guinea also hosted the ITU's Malabo Declaration of 22 May 2026, which commits signatories to the safe, ethical, inclusive and responsible use of artificial intelligence with particular emphasis on local and multilingual systems.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Since 2 September 2026 Facebook and TikTok have been unreachable without a VPN and bandwidth throttled, after a viral video accusing the Vice-President of corruption whose author was arrested; no government order or statement is held.

Freedom of expression and belief is Equatorial Guinea's most deteriorated of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, falling 18.3 points over 2014–2023 to 14.4 out of 100 and 53rd of 54 African states (2023). Digital freedom — censorship, filtering, shutdowns and reprisal-free use — stands at 16.8 out of 100 and 50th of 54, while media freedom stands at 31.6 and 48th of 54.

The rules governing what may be said online are now in use. Article 5 of Ley 7/2024 sets eleven prohibitions on users, among them publishing another person's data or images without express written consent, creating fake profiles, inciting hatred and spreading false news to attack third parties, with articles 6 to 8 adding a judicially enforceable duty of retraction; the propagation of false news through ICT sits among Título III's 40 offences. On 1 July 2026 the Presidency publicly reasserted the law's full force, citing a rise in reports of defamation, insult and identity usurpation by telematic means and warning of administrative and judicial action. On 16 September 2026 lawyers for the Vice-President lodged four criminal complaints under it against a digital newspaper's journalist and three others, invoking article 2 to reach conduct outside the national territory.

The press law dates from 1997, and the government has proposed replacing it with a bill regulating digital media and cable television for the first time. The overhaul is being carried by three separate bills — press freedom, audiovisual and digital communication services, and copyright and related rights — each presented to the Cámara de los Diputados on 7 August 2026, and the Chamber approved the press freedom and journalism bill unanimously on 11 September 2026. A Senate committee sent it to the plenary by consensus in October 2026, with a right of access to public information and the same protections for digital journalists; no text or commencement date is published. The Senate unanimously approved the country's first access-to-information instrument on 8 May 2026, scoped to the management of public funds and of funds granted by international institutions rather than to a general right of access.

Debate on digital policy is convened privately as often as officially: the digital-transformation forum held in Malabo on 22 July 2026 was organised by the consultancy AVANTE, with BANGE, GITGE and the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence on the panel. The standing channel the state created for consultation, the Observatorio Guinea Ecuatorial 2035, is named in Decreto 69/2021 as the principal means of consulting other public powers, civil society, the private sector and local government, but article 18 defers its composition and operation to a later decree.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Equatorial Guinea's own resources carry 93.9 per cent of the digital lines in the 2026 budget as appropriated, XAF 23.0 billion of XAF 24.5 billion, against 98.6 per cent of XAF 37.0 billion in 2024; the external share rests on a single project.

That project is public-finance modernisation: the 2026 investment programme gives it XAF 1.5 billion of external money and nothing from own resources, up from XAF 500 million in 2024 under the African Development Bank's name. Outside its investment programme the 2026 budget prints no financing source against its digital lines (FY2026). What it carries there is the state's own agencies and upkeep: a XAF 1.26 billion transfer to CNIAPGE, the agency that computerises the administration, and XAF 300 million for maintaining the Presidency's applications, licences and programming (2026), against XAF 800 million for that maintenance line in 2024.

The 2026 volume prints the 2024 outturn of the transfers to the digital agencies: CNIAPGE received XAF 1.17 billion and the business one-stop shop XAF 936 million, while the SYDONIA customs-system unit received XAF 393 million, against XAF 1.2 billion, XAF 960 million and XAF 840 million voted (2024).

The transport and telecommunications ministry's July–December 2026 plan requires frequency fees, port fees and registration charges to be paid in full into the Public Treasury. In September 2026 the Vice-President asked for talks with Meta and other platforms on how they should contribute to public revenue, and ordered Starlink's sales routed through the regulator ORTEL, with a dedicated bank account for the service's income.

The state operators GETESA and GITGE are on the list of public bodies to be privatised under the 2019 IMF programme (2022).

MoUs and other agreements

The government's central digital partnership is with Huawei: the Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Artificial Intelligence Systems signed a memorandum of understanding with the company on 28 December 2025 to accelerate the e-government project under the National Digitalisation Strategy, covering digital security, network coverage, digital education and complementary technology services. That relationship has since moved from intention to contracted work: GETESA and Huawei signed a contract at the Jefatura de Estado on 9 July 2026 for a six-month integral network-optimisation programme covering existing infrastructure, capacity, data-transmission speed and communications stability.

The other signature of the period looks to the region rather than to Beijing: on 9 February 2026 the government signed a strategic telecommunications agreement with Nigeria's Backbone Connectivity Network covering a submarine fibre-optic cable and a commercial data centre. Multilateral engagement has stopped short of an instrument: the ministry sat down with the World Bank in December 2025 to work up a strategy for the country's digital transformation, a convening that produced no financing and no timetable.

New investments

The largest external digital commitment still open on Equatorial Guinea's record is a USD 70,325,843 commercial loan from China Development Bank, signed in 2019 for a video surveillance project, undisbursed at 31 December 2019 with no principal or interest repaid. The larger loan is closed: China Eximbank lent USD 402,033,662 in 2015 as a buyer's credit for the CEIBA-2 submarine cable, paying a March 2015 contract between the state infrastructure manager GITGE and Huawei Marine Networks. It was a subsidiary drawing under a USD 2 billion oil-backed facility agreed with Eximbank in 2006, whose subsidiary loans carry 5.5 per cent interest, a five-year maturity and a two-year grace period, and was fully disbursed by 31 December 2019, USD 87,944,373 of principal repaid by then.

Aid is not the alternative. Equatorial Guinea received USD 11.2 million in official development assistance in 2023, 53rd of 54 African states and USD 6.7 per head, and the European Commission has no delegation in the country, running its cooperation from Yaoundé. ITU technical assistance covering eight Central African states, Equatorial Guinea among them, collected ICT indicators from 2021 to 2023 and has closed. What is in play now is unclosed:

EGSA Eloita put a US$50 million proposal to the Vice-President on 30 January 2026 to stand up a new operator, TELGESA, under negotiation rather than agreed, and a World Bank operation with the telecommunications ministry was still in preparation (September 2026).

Three external commitments in all are on the record, over a window from 2015 to 2023: the two Chinese loans, worth USD 472.4 million between them, and the regional ITU project, worth about USD 1 million across all eight countries. Both loans are non-concessional commercial debt rather than grants or credits; the technical assistance is the only non-debt instrument. Across that 2015-2023 window connectivity takes roughly 85 per cent of the money and surveillance equipment the remaining 15 per cent; nothing goes to digital identity, payments, e-government or skills. Every dollar of country-level finance comes from a Chinese state policy bank, and nothing new has been recorded since 2019.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Starlink became available in Equatorial Guinea on 29 August 2026 and was officially launched on 9 September, its sale reserved to the state, arriving in a market where a data-only mobile broadband plan cost about 10.3% of monthly gross national income per capita in 2022, five times the affordability target the UN Broadband Commission sets, and where mobile communications ranked the country 53rd of 54 African states in 2023 on the Ibrahim Index despite a 24.0-point rise over the preceding decade. About 65% of the population was within range of a 4G signal in 2024, and internet use stood at 60.4 users per 100 inhabitants in 2025. Since 2 September 2026 bandwidth has been throttled and Facebook and TikTok blocked.

There is no operational domestic internet exchange point: the state operator GITGE peers only at foreign exchanges, in Cape Town, Lagos, Accra, Lisbon and London, so traffic between two Equatoguinean networks is routed internationally (2025). An exchange entered the African Union's infrastructure project register in 2017 and stalled at construction stage with every cost, financing and completion field zero or blank. International capacity rests on the ACE consortium, joined in 2010 with close to 100 Gbps to Europe, and on CEIBA-2, a 400 km cable of 8 Tbps design capacity linking Malabo and Bata with a branch to Kribi in Cameroon; recurrent incidents on the ASD cable continue to degrade international connectivity (April 2026).

The domestic backbone was described in 2019 as four fibre rings, two insular and two continental, representing more than US$30 million invested. Annobón joined the national fibre network in April 2023 through the ULTRAMAR cable from São Tomé, begun in 2016 and halted for three years by the pandemic. Twenty of a planned 34 telecommunications towers along the Bata–Mongomo–Ebibeyin–Evinayong trunk road were handed over as operational on 23 September 2025, and a CAB-4 fibre interconnection with Gabon was launched at a signing in November 2025. Internet subscriptions rose 10.9% in 2024 while mobile telephony fell 3.2% and fixed telephony 11.8%. GETESA signed a six-month network-optimisation contract with Huawei on 9 July 2026 and raised the data volume in all eight of its prepaid packages by 50% from 14 August 2026 while holding prices. The digital terrestrial television project remains unbuilt after ten years with more than half its budget released, and the President asked Spain in October 2025 to work with him on returning the money.

The Vice-President instructed the finance ministry on 7 October 2026 to investigate and expedite the financing file for the operator's network agreement with the vendor, slowed by Treasury payment arrears to the operator.

Data Storage

Neither of the two data centres Equatorial Guinea is procuring for its public finances was built or operating as at July 2026; both had been specified and tendered only. The Public Finance Modernisation Support Project tendered in June 2026 for a primary data centre in Malabo and a solar-powered backup site in Bata, to store, process and back up the state's public financial data, both required to meet the TIA-942 data-centre standard under an African Development Bank-financed supervision contract that also covers drafting a business continuity plan and an information security management system. The server-room fit-out tender has had its bid deadline extended twice, most recently to 16 September 2026, and remained unawarded with no contractor, cost or delivery date on record (August 2026).

What exists is the state's own. GITGE operates national data-centre facilities serving government, and no national strategy for digital public platforms or a government cloud has been adopted (2024). CNIAPGE renewed the active and passive equipment of the state data centre in April 2025, describing it as guaranteeing the availability, custody and protection of the public administration's information, and the health ministry runs a separate data centre at its Malabo headquarters holding the national public-health database (March 2025). No data-localisation or residency requirement applies to any of it.

Energy

Electricity reached 66.9% of Equatorial Guinea's population in 2023 but only 2.4% of the rural population, against 89.0% in towns — a gap of 86.6 percentage points. Access to energy is nonetheless the country's strongest infrastructure measure on the Ibrahim Index, at 43.6 out of 100 and 24th of 54 African states, though it slipped 0.5 points over 2014-2023 rather than improving (2023). A third of firms, 33.3%, reported electrical outages in the 2024 World Bank Enterprise Survey, averaging 0.9 a month.

Solar mini-grids for rural and coastal communities are being established under a Joint SDG Fund programme, alongside donor-supported off-grid solar and small-hydro work (2024), and the backup data centre tendered for the public finances in June 2026 is specified to run on solar power. Infrastructure as a whole is the second-fastest improving of the Ibrahim Index's sixteen governance sub-categories for the country, up 8.7 points over 2014-2023 to 28.1 out of 100, which still leaves it 42nd of 54 (2023).

Technical Capacity

The Ibrahim Index rates the professionalism and delivery capability of Equatorial Guinea's state bureaucracy at 20.3 out of 100, 52nd of 54 African states, after a gain of 1.4 points over 2014-2023 (2023). Public administration is nonetheless among the country's fastest-improving sub-categories, up 7.0 points to 26.6 out of 100 over the same decade and still 51st of 54 (2023); its standing on the UN's e-government index is comparably low (2024).

Equipment and training arrive in identifiable batches rather than as a programme. The launch of the health ministry's routine health information system came with 50 laptops, 30 tablets, 20 desktops, 15 multifunction printers, 10 scanners and 100 digital workstations, and more than 100 digital agents trained (March 2025). Officials from across the sectors were put through an intensive digital-transformation, citizen-centred design and cybersecurity course run with UNDP from August 2025. The government's own inspection visits had already found its regional delegations short of computer equipment, office supplies and transport (July 2023).

The technical-assistance mission procured in June 2026 for the two public-finance data centres also carries further training of the state's own technical staff. GETESA's strategic plan for 2026-2030, approved on 3 July 2026, directs the operator to take network maintenance progressively in-house and to train its own staff.

Cybersecurity

No systematic security audit, penetration test or vulnerability assessment of Equatorial Guinea's national systems, the identity system among them, has been carried out, and the World Bank puts a first cybersecurity maturity assessment among its quick-win reforms (2024).

The statutory framework is newer than the practice. Ley 7/2024 creates an Agencia Nacional de Ciberseguridad e Infraestructuras Críticas and caps its administrative sanctions at 20,000,000 F CFA, and the same law punishes disclosing a password or access credential for gain or to commit an offence with five to eight years' imprisonment and a fine of 1,000,000 to 10,000,000 F CFA. It carries a criminal-procedure chapter covering data preservation orders, search and seizure of computer systems, extradition and mutual legal assistance.

The Prime Minister brought the telecommunications ministry and the mobile operators together on 9 December 2025 over rising digital fraud and unstable coverage; the operators attributed part of the fraud to abandoned WhatsApp sessions and committed to stricter registration controls, and the ministry contracted CIBERTEC to audit national coverage. In October 2026 the Vice-President alleged that a registry official had handed a hard drive of several years of the Presidency's administrative files to a foreign national under cover of an archive-digitisation project, which the government presents as the country's largest leak of official documents; the account is the government's own and no judicial finding is held. A China Development Bank loan signed in 2019 for a video surveillance project remained undisbursed at the end of that year.

DPI

Data Exchange

Equatorial Guinea's National Development Agency named limited data-sharing by line ministries as its main obstacle to monitoring alignment with the National Sustainable Development Strategy, at the agency's directorship handover on 7 August 2026. That is the working face of a structural absence: the country has no national interoperability framework and no government data exchange layer, ministries build digital systems in silos, and the only cross-agency sharing is ad hoc and manual, by email or USB (2024). No sector system exchanges data with another through a shared government platform — health records, education and learner data, justice, tax, social protection, driver licensing, passports and immigration, agriculture, employment and electoral registration all stand alone (2024).

What integration exists is sectoral or regional rather than national. The tax authority is pursuing interconnection with customs and the Treasury under the PAMFP public finance reform programme, a link inside the Ministry of Finance. Regionally, the BEAC and the IFC launched the CEMAC credit bureau at Douala on 20 January 2026 on a hub-and-spokes model with the hub in Cameroon, national representative offices to follow progressively across the other five member states, Equatorial Guinea among them.

The instruments that would change the domestic picture are not yet instruments. A public-procurement bill in the Senate would establish an electronic public procurement and contracting information system adapted to CEMAC requirements (November 2025). The steering committee of the SIGF civil-service system named its principal challenge in June 2026 as institutional rather than technological — biometric management, access control and interoperability between institutions. A 2026 study by the state telecommunications operator GITGE found a wide digital-transformation gap across ministries, interoperability included. The statistical programmes committee recommended in April 2026 that ministerial statistical services be given access to administrative registers for strictly statistical purposes and a means of exchanging data with INEGE.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Equatorial Guinea has no functional digital identity or digital authentication system: the biometric chip in the national identity card is not used for any electronic verification, there is no operational trust framework, and the electronic signature platform planned since 2017 has never been implemented (2024). The World Bank's ID4D dataset estimates that about 63% of adults hold the Documento de Identidad Personal, coverage higher on Bioko than in the continental provinces (2022), though the card is mandatory from age 18 and required for all public services (2024). CNEDOGE has run an internal electronic database for document issuance since 2018 that is interoperable with nothing else, and no systematic integration exists between the card and the tax register, any population register, the civil registry or social insurance, whose number is a different number altogether (2024). The civil-registration statute in force is still Spain's law of 8 June 1957, under which no unique identifier is assigned at birth (2025).

The constraint on issuance is physical rather than digital. CNEDOGE's Director General told deputies in April 2025 that booklets and plates were out of stock, that the centre neither owns the consumables nor is funded for them through the Treasury, and that applications are validated so they can be printed when stock arrives; the same session heard that fees invert between first issue and renewal, 7,500 XAF for a passport against 10,000 XAF to renew it. Annobón has no permanent CNEDOGE office and received a seven-day documentation mission from mid-July 2026, issuing documents on the island for the first time to residents reaching majority.

Passports are where the biometric estate is real. 7,706 CEMAC biometric passports were issued through diplomatic missions between 2022 and 2026, and six representations are operational for biometric capture while others hold the machines but await installation and training (May 2026). The reglamento requires the passport number to equal the identity-card number but specifies no deduplication method, coverage target, audit rule or grievance procedure. The criminal fingerprint database AFIS needs reactivating, listed in the security ministry's draft 2026 budget.

The justice ministry announced in April 2025 the activation of civil registry offices in every district beyond Bata and Malabo. A multisector commission under the first deputy prime minister began redrafting the 1957 Civil Registry Law in January 2026.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Orden de la Presidencia 3/2025 of 10 September 2025 prohibits cash collection of taxes, charges and any other public revenue, routing it to Treasury accounts, collaborating banks or official electronic platforms authorised by the government — but no list of those platforms has been published, and the order leaves the list of accounts, sellers and channels still to be issued. Its one transitional exception, for sellers of efectos de valor, expires when electronic payment systems are implemented, which the order does not date.

The state's own rails are part-built. The General Treasury piloted card payment of fiscal obligations at Malabo windows in late 2025. The government has completed a census of all state bank accounts and adopted a five-phase roadmap for a Treasury Single Account targeted for production in the first quarter of 2027, to be built on AMS/X and SINTAG, platforms already in use at the BEAC. Payments out are further behind: salaries and pensions are made manually and no G2P or P2G digitisation strategy exists (2024), though INSESO told deputies in September 2025 that all social benefits now reach beneficiaries' bank accounts bar the bedridden and severely disabled.

The retail market is thin. Access to banking scores 7.4 out of 100 in the Ibrahim Index, 45th of 54 African states (2023), and the first e-money operator was licensed only in mid-2023. A national plan to deploy cash machines and card terminals launched in May 2025, banks warning that network outages compromise the devices; the Vice-

President pressed the five commercial banks and the BEAC in February 2026 to widen terminal and card coverage, and in April ordered BANGE to repay about 182 million FCFA to some 12,000 customers over improperly timed loan-arrears charges.

The regional plumbing moved in 2026 while the country's weight in it stayed small. SYSTAC 2 entered production on 3 August 2026 across all six CEMAC states, but its instant-payments module was not in production as at 12 August 2026 and SYGMA V10 had no announced date. Equatorial Guinea accounted for 0.41% of CEMAC payment volume in 2024.

Registries

The one register operating at national scale in Equatorial Guinea is INSESO's social-security affiliate roll, at 137,445 accumulated affiliates as at 31 December 2024 — and a 2024 pensioner census found 2,282 entries untraceable, unresolved, deceased or fraudulently entered, saving roughly 4 billion FCFA. There is no continuously updated population register, the last census taken in 2015; no social registry and no national social assistance programme, spending running around 0.1% of GDP (2025); and no postcode, the addressing guide filed with the Universal Postal Union in March 2023 carrying no postcode field.

Civil registration has moved furthest and reaches least. SIREC entered service in December 2018, and converted 192,000 birth records covering 1980–2019, all of it at the central registry, but has not been extended nationwide for want of funding, the seven regional offices still working on paper. Digitisation has produced electronic certificates carrying QR codes through APP RC (March 2025). Vital statistics are assembled separately, from hospital registers and community focal-point forms; the second report recorded 14,667 births and 2,805 deaths in 2024, 64.6% of the deaths outside hospital.

Land is registered document by document. Ley 4/2009 makes ownership turn on a concession granted by the Presidency and preserves immemorial occupation even where unregistered. The Chamber of Deputies approved a Catastro Nacional de Tierras bill on 7 May 2025; the first field phase opened in Bata's Obispado on 16 June 2026 as a paper document-collection exercise. The Land Registry is connected to no other government register.

Business registration now runs on two compulsory tracks. The Ventanilla Única Empresarial was created by Decreto 67/2017 as the Registro Único de Empresas. Since 1 January 2026, Orden de la Presidencia 4/2025 has required a chamber-of-commerce Certificado de Alta from any economic operator before a public entity may contract with or pay it — a second compulsory register under a different institution, with nothing stating which governs when they disagree. The electoral register is not a register either: Decreto 34/2022 orders a periodic electoral census, with no biometric capture and voting on presentation of a card without verification against the identity system (2024). The census of June to August 2022 produced a roll of 427,663 voters in 1,486 voting centres and stations for that November's elections.

Sectoral management information systems

Health has the only working sectoral system, and it covers two districts. DHIS2 was launched at Baney on 1 March 2025 under a UN Joint Programme, giving district-level care, vaccination, workforce and medicine-stock data; the pilot in Baney and continental Añisok was declared complete on 25 November 2025 and named the reference for a national expansion foreseen in 2026. The system it replaces is manual: health data were collected on register sheets filled in at each facility, which ministry staff periodically gathered and transferred to spreadsheets (2025). The ministry also runs TRANSDOC and a Data Center at its Malabo headquarters.

The civil service has the most invested and the least delivered. SIGF, supplied by Morocco's M2M Group, centralises civil-servant records with biometric attendance recording and automated payroll; by its steering committee's third meeting on 17 June 2026 it had reviewed 22 procedures, described as the technical base for biometric identification of civil and military personnel nationwide. It follows a 2023 enrolment drive covering more than 87,000 public servants and contract workers. The existing HR application, APP SIRH, had more than 20,147 civil servants registered as at March 2025; the ninth national yearbook puts the civil service at 20,152 staff in 2025, with 2,731 hires that year, down 20.5%.

Tax administration is three years into a system that has not gone live. SIGREF was contracted on 23 October 2023 under the AfDB-financed PAMFP programme, with completion foreseen for the first quarter of 2026; on 28 May 2026 the ministry was still reviewing the procedures manual and the system's modules, with a reliable padrón tributario as the stated aim.

Education statistics run on their own track, produced by the ministry's statistical unit with PRODEGE, drawn from SIME and the annual school census. The ministry's own most recent yearbook appeared in May 2023, covering 2020/21; volumes for 2021/22 and 2022/23 were launched on 20 May 2026 and handed to UNICEF, UNDP, UNESCO and the African Development Bank as documents, not as data, and the 2025/26 census launched in Bata in June 2026 is collected on questionnaires that inspectors distribute to schools. Justice and policing have plans only: an action plan of 6 October 2025 covering digitisation of judicial records, and police-process digitalisation in the draft 2026 security budget.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Equatorial Guinea's second interministerial council of 2026, on 10 August, agreed to create corporate e-mail accounts for government members and public officials. That is the altitude of the estate: the country scored 0.2855 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, 176th of 193 member states, and the one government digital service with a published throughput figure is the online visa system, which approved 10,468 applications in 2024.

The programme sits with CNIAPGE, under the Presidency. Its director-general enumerated five systems in service in March 2025 — the e-Gob platform, APP SIRH for human resources, APP RC for the civil registry, BOE Digital for laws and regulations, and APP GEX for administrative file management. The second phase of the informatisation project launched on 10 November 2023, extending case-file digitisation from a Presidency and Justice pilot to the rest of the administration, and the 2024 plan set eight objectives: local networks, a building for a state data centre, a fibre ring joining every ministry, digitising the Prime Minister's workflows, institutional email, IP telephony, videoconferencing and enabling legislation.

The delivery record is candid. At the same March 2024 board CNIAPGE recorded an outstanding debt to the state connectivity operator GITGE and an incomplete equipment inventory, and the Prime Minister asked when the first phase had actually ended and what the second contained. A year later the board gave CNIAPGE total control of the acquisition, installation and maintenance of IT equipment across the administration and barred ministries from acquiring equipment without its supervision. Services arrive one at a time: SIGOB was launched from Bata on 17 June 2021 to let citizens track an administrative procedure online, CNEDOGE enabled online appointments alongside new provincial offices at Mongomo and Ciudad de la Paz on 12 June 2026 — a digitisation of the queue rather than of the credential — and INAP launched its first institutional website on 10 August 2026. Public spending runs through CONFIN, an integrated public-finance management system for the current-expenditure budget, whose directives for use across the administration and autonomous bodies went to the interministerial council on 10 February 2025. The government announced a digital edition of the official gazette on 6 October 2026, with free online access and search of past publications.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Many of Equatorial Guinea's cities still work from colonial-era or incomplete street and parcel plans, with streets lacking codes and nomenclature, the Delegate Minister of the Interior and Local Administration told the Chamber of Deputies on 23 March 2026; updated plans are the basis the cadastre and the property register would be built on, and the Malabo and Bata study begun towards them was left unfinished, with the commission carrying it forward working to no stated timetable or budget.

The offices that would do the work are short of the equipment to do it with. Ministerial inspection visits to the Delegaciones Regionales, the sub-national arm of central administration, found poor infrastructure and insufficient computer equipment, office supplies and transport, as recorded at the Council of Ministers sitting of 14 July 2023 in Bata, the same sitting setting down the regional delegations' ICT infrastructure as poor.

The e-government services set out for the continental region in March 2025 are in Bata — official training, civil-registry improvements, DGT Digital for vehicle management, and pre-registration of births from reference hospitals. Beneath them the underlying process is unchanged: civil registration runs as a centralised, manual one, with no electronic exchange of records between local registry offices and the central level (2017).

UNDP lists the ayuntamientos of Malabo and Bata among its government partners in the country (2024). Away from the two cities the administration travels to the citizen rather than the other way about: Annobón has no permanent office of the national document-issuing centre and depends on periodic commissions from the mainland, the most recent a seven-day deployment from mid-July 2026 that issued identity documents and passports on the island to residents reaching majority.

Rural digital data capture

Health is where digital data capture has reached rural Equatorial Guinea: a pilot put direct entry into health facilities in the continental interior district of Añisok and in coastal Baney between February and May 2025, replacing the manual monthly activity sheets in both. The health ministry declared the pilot complete on 25 November 2025 and named it the reference for a national expansion foreseen for 2026. Before the platform, health data were collected manually on register sheets filled in at each facility, which ministry staff periodically gathered and transferred to spreadsheets (2025).

Schools in the interior are being equipped ahead of any system for what they record: the Ministry of Education handed over a computer room of 30 desktop computers, printers, a laptop, a projector and six-camera CCTV to the Centro Integrado de Nsok Nsomo in Kié-Ntem on 15 March 2026. The national education Anuario was launched for 2021-22 and 2022-23 with copies handed to international partners (2026), and its tables are broken down by zona, so the school census does collect an urban and rural split at the point of collection (May 2023). ProFuturo's digital-education schools sit in Bata, Malabo and interior schools of the continental region (December 2021).

Digital services are concentrated in urban and capital areas, and the World Bank puts the island-continental divide, with weak connectivity on the mainland holding back access to them, among the country's cross-cutting obstacles (2024). The physical preconditions run behind that: rural electricity access is a small fraction of the urban rate (2023), and the first phase of a mast programme along the Bata-Mongomo-Ebibeyin-Evinayong trunk road was handed over as operational on 23 September 2025, with a further phase still to build.

Rural Equatorial Guinea is also close to unmeasured: none of the four indicators in the Ibrahim Index's Rural Economy sub-category carries a score for the country (2023).

Technology

AI

Equatorial Guinea's artificial intelligence brief changed hands in mid-2026, when Presidential Decree 61/2026 transferred the Secretary-of-State post to Óscar Ondo Ngomo on 23 June 2026. The post dates from 23 August 2024, when Decree 86/2024 named José Eko Owono to it. Both holders have sat inside the transport and telecommunications ministry rather than a digital one, and Ondo Ngomo took office there on 7 July 2026 alongside a Director-General for AI Systems, Reginaldo Boriko Okomo (July 2026).

No artificial intelligence instrument has been enacted. An anteproyecto proposing a national regulator, ANIAD, the Autoridad Nacional de Inteligencia Artificial y Datos, was in circulation from August 2025, its drafters framing it against the African Union's 2014 Malabo Convention and Agenda 2063 and against ECCAS and Smart Africa strategies rather than against any national digital strategy. The law in force on social media and cybercrime, Ley 7/2024, is technology-neutral and names neither artificial intelligence nor deepfakes, leaving no AI-specific provision against synthetic-media abuse. Nor does the state's own computerisation work use the technology: CNIAPGE's 2024 action plan for computerising the public administration names no artificial-intelligence or machine-learning component among its eight general objectives. The one public deployment on record is in health: the ministry launched the Guinea Salud chatbot as a pilot on 6 June 2025 with MCD Global Health, answering on vaccination, medical evacuation, clinic licensing and HIV.

Activity is running ahead of the framework. The second Foro Nacional de Inteligencia Artificial ran 12–14 May 2026 at the Afro-American University of Central Africa in Ciudad de la Paz, sponsored by Deep Learning Indaba, with the telecommunications ministry, UNGE, INSTTIC, MUNI and GITGE on its high-level panel and a technical session on classroom adoption. In the same month the cabinet approved a modernisation programme for the state operator GETESA committing it to AI-based customer-service and customer-retention systems (May 2026), and the country hosted the ITU's Malabo Declaration on the safe, ethical and resource-efficient use of artificial intelligence. Abroad, INEGE's director-general, speaking for the African Group at the UN Statistical Commission in March 2026, argued for integrating artificial intelligence into health systems under governance guaranteeing data protection and human rights. The state budget section covering transport, telecommunications and artificial-intelligence systems was nonetheless cut for 2026.

ICT Industry

What movement there is in the sector is in the state's own companies rather than in private firms. Salvador Nguema Funtam took over as head of the state ICT operator GITGE on 7 August 2026, two weeks after the merger of the state telecoms holding TELGESA with Loita Group was halted pending a full audit of GECOMSA's financial position, assets, liabilities and debts (July 2026). Director-general posts at state-participation entities including GITGE are being filled by competitive interview against stated criteria, with appointments provisional for six months and terminable if the entity's objectives are not met (July 2026). GETESA, SEGESA, GECOTEL, GITGE and two others have meanwhile sat on the finance ministry's list of state bodies to be privatised with no completed transaction recorded.

The legal architecture is being rebuilt around them. The Senate passed a general law on special economic zones on 8 May 2026, framed as the route away from hydrocarbon dependence toward petrochemical, industrial and energy zones in the Gulf of Guinea. A copyright and related rights bill reached the Chamber of Deputies on 7 August 2026, implementing the 1997 Berne accession and the 2015 ratification of the Bangui Agreement and extending protection to new technological modes of distributing and consuming protected works.

Private firms remain few and the payments layer is where that bites. Banks and telecom operators, rather than independent fintechs, dominate the market (2026), and digital content creators told a Vice-Presidency working meeting in April 2026 that banking and administrative obstacles prevent them being paid, the banking sector undertaking to bring proposals to a following meeting; Alibaba attended the same meeting. The transport ministry's semestral plan of July 2026 sets a youth-employment target for the digital economy. The investment setting behind all of it is unchanged: the US State Department's 2025 investment climate assessment records no bilateral investment treaty and no double-taxation treaty with the United States, underinvestment in critical infrastructure such as power generation, and major investment decisions still taken at presidential and vice-presidential level.

Innovation ecosystem

Equatorial Guinea does not appear in the international innovation rankings at all: it is not among the 133 economies ranked in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, so there is no score or rank to track over time. The formal sector is thin behind that absence. The pan-African AfriLabs network lists a single member innovation and incubation centre in the country, Dreams Hub in Malabo (2025), and a startup tracker's listing of Equatoguinean companies shows only a handful with any disclosed funding at all, together well under a million US dollars (2026).

What has been built is small and run by donors and foundations. Dreams Hub opened its La Capsula incubator in Malabo on 30 July 2022, with TotalEnergies Startupper winners as its first cohort; UNDP's Guinea ON project with the telecommunications ministry trained some 60 young people and funded ten technology startups at 6 million CFA each during 2022; and the IDENTIC Foundation signed incubation agreements with six projects in March 2026. No startup law is in force, and the foundation and the Bioko chamber of commerce called for one in February 2026.

The rest is planned. The Long-Term Strategic Plan approved in 2024 commits the country to introducing digital literacy from primary level and to establishing innovation centres, commitments that remain forward-looking. A World Bank-supported telecommunications programme announced in September 2026 lists regulatory sandboxes, a telecoms-sector business incubator, a future digital services law, a data-management and protection policy and institutional strengthening of the regulator ORTEL among its planned measures. Separately, a draft CEMAC payment-services regulation under review in June 2026 would open a twelve-month regulatory sandbox to fintechs and payment aggregators in Equatorial Guinea, alongside mandatory strong authentication and a reversed burden of proof in fraud disputes.

Capacity

Literacy

Information technology is not a formal component of Equatorial Guinea's national school curriculum (2024), and no data exist to compute what share of the population holds basic, intermediate or advanced digital skills. The same diagnostic records no national ICT education policy behind that absence.

The country's education enrolment score of 19.3 out of 100 ranks 49th of 54 African states and has fallen 1.3 points over the decade to 2023, while equality in education is one of its ten best-scoring indicators, at 58.6 out of 100 and 19th on the continent, up 6.5 points across the same period — what schooling there is, is spread comparatively evenly. The index carries no score at all for education completion or for human resources in education (2023), so whether pupils finish and whether there are teachers to teach them go unmeasured.

Provision outside the curriculum is donor-shaped and small. E-tic, a virtual digital-skills training centre, opened to the public on 1 July 2021 under founder-director Rosa Hinestrosa Gómez, building two online courses on the UNESCO and OECD digital-competence frameworks for citizens and for teachers. ProFuturo's programme with the Catholic teaching-centres association ACCEGE, running since a November 2017 agreement, reported reaching

around 16,000 children and several hundred teachers across a few dozen schools (December 2021). Within the state system, Minister of State for Education Clemente Engonga Nguema names computing and communications among the priority technical trades under the Ley General de Educación (January 2026). The government's director-general for artificial intelligence, Reginaldo Boricó, holds that social acceptance, awareness and digital literacy, not infrastructure, decide whether digital adoption holds (July 2026).

Five distinct digital-skills and education-technology initiatives are on record since 2021, and none of them has produced the population-level skills measurement the 2024 diagnostic found missing.

Training and skills

Fifty trainers were selected from 466 applications in Malabo for the UniPod Formación de Formadores programme (July 2026), narrowing through 315 eligible, 110 shortlisted and 94 interviewed candidates, run by the Ministries of Education and of Telecommunications with UNDP's pan-African Timbuktoo platform and the incubator IDENTIC. The twenty best trainers from Malabo and Bata are to cascade the training nationally during August and September 2026.

Days earlier, a UNESCO train-the-trainers programme opened in Malabo (4 July 2026), running with the Ministry of Education to 2028 in artificial intelligence, 3D design and printing and Scratch programming, with agriculture and health as its priority application sectors.

Public-administration training has its own line. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs, International Cooperation and Diaspora and UNDP launched an intensive Digital Fitness programme for the public sector in August 2025, covering digital transformation, citizen-centred design and cybersecurity, through UNDP's Global Digitalisation Office. The earlier state effort ran through CNIAPGE, whose first phase trained civil servants as informatisation focal points and equipped five training rooms (January 2019). Sector programmes add their own cohorts, among them the health professionals trained under the DHIS2 pilot in Baney and Añisok (November 2025).

Beneath the donor programmes the standing provision is thin. The state operator GITGE runs its own skills initiatives, including TEG Campus hackathons and the Conéctate schools programme (2024), and E-tic has offered online citizen and teacher courses since 2021. In the technical and vocational stream the government has rehabilitated the workshops of the Instituto Politécnico Modesto Gené Roig in Bata and the technical-training centres in Bata, Mongomo and Oyala (January 2026), with computing named among the trades those centres are meant to carry.

Research institutions

The second national artificial-intelligence forum ran at the Afro-American University of Central Africa in Ciudad de la Paz on 12–14 May 2026, sponsored by Deep Learning Indaba, with the telecommunications ministry, the National University of Equatorial Guinea, INSTTIC, MUNI and GITGE on its high-level panel. Alongside it, a Transport, Telecommunications and AI Systems ministry delegation met AAUCA, UNGE and INSTTIC on adopting artificial intelligence in the classroom and on UNESCO's recommendations.

The institutions that would host any of this work are few: tertiary engineering and computing teaching is concentrated in the public National University of Equatorial Guinea, through its Faculty of Architecture and Engineering in Bata and its engineering school in Malabo, with a small number of private institutions alongside (2025).

Inclusion

Access to services

Equal access to public services scores 12.7 out of 100, 52nd of 54 African states, and has fallen 2.7 points over 2014-2023 (2023): state services in Equatorial Guinea are becoming less evenly distributed, not more.

Getting to a service means producing a physical document. The social security number is a different number from the national identity number and civil registry data is not available to social-sector ministries (2024), so every counter checks paper of its own; national identity card coverage leaves a substantial minority of adults out and is thinner in the continental provinces than on Bioko (2022), and documents are not issued free of charge (2024). Issuance has been held up by shortages of booklets and plates rather than by systems (April 2025), and the remedies the Chamber of Deputies took from its April 2025 review of CNEDOGE were access remedies — cutting delays and extending issuance to more diplomatic offices and embassies abroad.

Distance compounds it. Annobón has no permanent document-issuing office and is reached only by periodic visits, leaving residents otherwise to travel to Malabo or Bata (July 2026), while services were extended to further continental locations from 12 June 2026. Behind the counter there is no national social assistance programme and no social registry to target benefits through (2025), and social benefits are now paid directly into beneficiaries' bank accounts (September 2025), which moves the problem onto one of the lowest levels of banking access on the continent (2023).

Digital public platforms are nascent and carry no documented accessibility features for disabled or elderly users, digital literacy is low across the population and there is no national ICT education policy (2024).

Complaint channels exist and publish nothing on their use: the Ombudsman opened a complaints website on 28 September 2022, an online anti-corruption reporting portal taking anonymous reports was cleared for operation on 24 October 2024, and the health ministry's patient-ombudsman office takes complaints through an online form, none of them with a stated volume or response time.

For non-citizens the legal route stops short: Equatorial Guinea has acceded to the 1951 Refugee Convention and its 1967 Protocol, the 1969 OAU Refugee Convention and the Kampala Convention, but has no domestic refugee-status-determination law and no comprehensive procedure for identifying stateless people, with nationality governed by the Constitution and the Equatoguinean Nationality Regulation (September 2026).

Digital divides

Women's access to public services is one of Equatorial Guinea's ten most deteriorated governance measures, down 6.0 points over 2014-2023 to 9.7 out of 100 and 51st of 54 African states (2023). It is a country with the sixth highest GDP per capita in Africa, USD 7,066.6 on a population of 1.7 million, and a governance rank of 50th of 54 (2023): the money is there and the services are not.

The sharpest internal divide is geographic. Digital services cluster in the capital and other urban areas, and weak connectivity on the continental mainland holds back access to them (2024), while rural electricity access is close to absent (2023), which caps what any device-based service can reach outside the towns. New towers along the Bata-Mongomo-Ebibeyin-Evinayong trunk road came into service in September 2025 with a further phase still to build, and donor-funded school digitisation runs through Bata, Malabo and interior continental schools, with neither Annobón nor Corisco named (December 2021).

The gender divide is measured and wide: substantially fewer women than men use mobile internet (2023). Schooling is the exception, distributed comparatively evenly and one of the country's ten best scoring governance indicators (2023), though what that measures is how evenly a thin provision is spread.

Two responses are on the record and both are small. A virtual training centre opened in 2021 pricing its courses for the whole population and framing itself as a measure against the country's digital divide, and a solar-powered portable digital library that generates its own local wifi network without any internet connection was presented to the finance and education ministries on 7 April 2026. The government's director-general for artificial intelligence argues that social acceptance, awareness and digital literacy, rather than infrastructure, decide whether digital adoption holds (July 2026).

Data

National statistics

Equatorial Guinea's headline population figure is a projection rather than a count: INEGE's Cifras compendium gives 1,668,768 for 2024, carried forward from the 2015 census enumeration of 1,225,377. A fifth Censo General de Población y Vivienda and a first Censo General Agropecuario were ordered by Decreto núm. 25/2025 of 3 March, and the Scientific Committee accompanying them met for the first time on 20 August 2026 to validate the strategic and resource-mobilisation documents, with no enumeration date set. A week later the Consejo Nacional de Estadística heard a proposal to run the two as a single operation, alongside a second Demographic and Health Survey and a second Labour Force, Training and Employment Survey (27 August 2026) — an idea traced to six INEGE statisticians who spent 10-16 August 2026 in Burundi studying that country's combined, fully digital 2024 census.

The Ibrahim Index scores the statistical system at 33.6 out of 100, 44th of 54 African states and up 2.1 points across 2014-2023 (2023), and carries no data at all for 22 of its 96 indicators for the country. On the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators, four of the five pillars — data use, data services, data sources and data infrastructure — fall in the 20-49% band, and no agricultural, business or labour force survey has been run in the past decade, against one health survey and one household survey (2023).

INEGE presented the ninth Anuario Estadístico de Guinea Ecuatorial in Malabo on 25 September 2026, covering the last five years, and named weak administrative registers, undigitised processes and poor interoperability between information systems among the statistical system's outstanding challenges. The series is assembled from line-ministry returns rather than registers, the eighth edition of October 2025 being the first to appear in French as well as Spanish. Work opened in April 2026 on a successor to the 2022-2026 Estrategia Nacional de Desarrollo de la Estadística, with no adoption date published for ENDE 2027-2031. A first Catálogo Nacional de Indicadores, launched with AFRISTAT support at Malabo on 24 June 2026, is to homogenise calculation methods across the statistical system, and a technical committee chaired by INEGE's director-general began implementing the 2008 System of National Accounts, approving the product and activity nomenclatures at its first meeting in February 2026.

Open data

There are five domains in which Equatorial Guinea publishes no openly available official statistics at all — digital, built environment, pollution, food security and poverty — each scoring zero out of ten on Open Data Watch's Open Data Inventory (2024). Where the country does publish, the same inventory scores it middling to poor: government finance is its strongest category at 7 out of 10 and balance of payments 6, while energy, banking, national accounts, labour, education, health and population sit between 3 and 4.5, and crime and reproductive health statistics score 2 (2024).

The Ibrahim Index puts disclosure of public records — whether the state publishes budgets, asset declarations and official information as a matter of course — at 9.8 out of 100, 51st of 54 African states and static across 2014-2023 (2023). Whether citizens can in practice obtain government information is the country's eighth most improved indicator, up 8.1 points over the same decade, and still 11.8 out of 100 and 45th of 54 (2023).

The Senate unanimously passed the Proyecto de Ley de Transparencia, Acceso a la Información Pública y Buen Gobierno en la Gestión de Finanzas Públicas on 8 May 2026, the country's first access-to-information instrument, though it is scoped to the management of public and internationally granted funds rather than to a general right of access, and it remains a bill.

Publication is otherwise a matter of documents handed over. The ninth Anuario Estadístico was presented to ministries, agencies and diplomatic missions on 25 September 2026, and the education ministry's yearbooks for 2021-22 and 2022-23 were formally handed to UNICEF, UNDP, UNESCO and the African Development Bank at their launch on 20 May 2026.

Use of satellite data

The earth-observation and hydrometeorological data Equatorial Guinea works from is regional rather than national: as an ECCAS member state it is covered by a sub-regional WIGOS observing network feeding the WMO Information Systems, a consolidating regional specialised meteorological centre at Yaoundé, and an ECCAS Situation Room operational at Douala since September 2024 under the continental AMHEWAS early-warning system (November 2025). That architecture gained a coordination layer at N'Djamena on 10-12 February 2026, where the ten ECCAS states' meteorological, hydrological and disaster-risk institutions formalised communication frameworks with the regional centres under CREWS Central Africa and the Early Warnings for All initiative.

Land administration gives survey and imagery nothing to attach to: Ley 4/2009 substitutes a document-by-document concession inquiry for a cadastre and creates neither a cadastre nor a systematic land survey.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The clearest American commercial arrival in Equatorial Guinea's digital sector sits on a backbone financed and built by Chinese lenders and vendors: Starlink went on sale on 29 August 2026, weeks after United States offshore oil operators were cleared to use the service in the country's jurisdictional waters (July 2026).

Washington's own reading of the country is unflattering. The State Department's 2025 Investment Climate Statement records that Equatorial Guinea has neither a bilateral investment treaty nor a double-taxation treaty with the United States, that critical infrastructure including power generation is underinvested, and that major investment decisions are still taken at presidential and vice-presidential level — a description of a market that runs on personal decision rather than on rules, and the reason American commercial interest has stayed in hydrocarbons.

Official engagement otherwise runs through the multilateral channel and the diaspora. A World Bank mission worked in Malabo in early September 2026 with ORTEL, GITGE, CNIAPGE and ministry technical teams on the national digital economy strategy, the sector's legal and regulatory framework, and a Bank-financed project to follow it. Separately, a CNEDOGE technical team was in Houston in July 2026 installing a passport processing and issuance unit at the consulate general, extending the national issuance system to the diaspora in the United States.

China activities

Huawei is now the state's default digital partner, and the arrangement reaches into the machinery of government rather than sitting alongside it. The Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Artificial Intelligence Systems signed a memorandum of understanding with the company on 28 December 2025 to accelerate the e-government project, and execution of it is to be coordinated across CNIAPGE for central-administration digitalisation, the regulator ORTEL, the civil-service ministry for administrative re-engineering, and the operators MUNI and GETESA, agreed after a meeting between the President and Huawei's North Africa president in November 2025. GETESA signed its own contract with Huawei on 9 July 2026 for a six-month network-optimisation programme, Huawei was the first caller on GITGE's new director general in August 2026, and the Vice-President recommended in June 2026 that the state electricity utility SEGESA form a company to commercialise fibre on the power grid, working with Huawei or a comparable firm.

The external financing behind the digital infrastructure is Chinese and a decade old. China Eximbank financed the CEIBA-2 submarine cable in 2015 as a subsidiary loan under an oil-backed buyer's credit facility agreed in 2006, its proceeds paying a commercial contract between GITGE and Huawei Marine Networks; the cable is also what joins the ACE system to Cameroon, the two landing stations in Bata sitting together. China Development Bank's 2019 loan for a video surveillance project was still undrawn at the end of that year, and is understood to fund cameras at the Presidential Palace, Malabo International Airport and the Malabo–Sipopo highway, with ZTE responsible for most of the work.

China committed in June 2025 to support Equatorial Guinea's technological development in cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and critical-infrastructure management after the Vice-President's visit to Beijing, under a cooperation roadmap aimed at making the country a Central African technology hub: training for more than 200 INSTTIC students with Chinese universities, a cybersecurity and artificial intelligence forum at Djibloho, and Equatorial Guinea's co-chairing of FOCAC in 2027. Alibaba joined a government working meeting on e-commerce and digital payments in April 2026 chaired by the Vice-President.

EU activities

The European Union has no delegation in Equatorial Guinea, no bilateral allocation under the 11th European Development Fund and no multiannual indicative programme under NDICI for 2021-2027 (September 2026); cooperation is run from Yaoundé. On the two instruments that carry most EU digital money into African partner countries, Equatorial Guinea is simply absent.

What remains is thematic and regional. EU support runs through civil-society and human-rights programmes and, through ECCAS membership, regional maritime-security, AfriIPI and aviation-fuel programmes, with a Team Europe civil-society roadmap in preparation (September 2026). None of it is a digital or connectivity channel, and none of it is bilateral.

The most substantial European thread in the sector is a dispute rather than a programme. Equatorial Guinea's digital terrestrial television project remains unbuilt after ten years despite more than half its budget having been released, and the President raised it with Spain's chargé d'affaires on 22 October 2025, asking the two governments to work together on the return of the funds.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state or Emirati investor held a digital-sector agreement, financing commitment or operating presence in Equatorial Guinea as at September 2026.

India activities

India had no digital cooperation programme, financing commitment or vendor presence in Equatorial Guinea as at September 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Equatorial Guinea has set out to take back its country-code domain: the transport and telecommunications ministry's July–December 2026 plan creates a National Negotiation Commission to recover .GQ, which a foreign operator manages (July 2026). In September the government cancelled Starlink contracts obtained outside official channels, put sales under the regulator ORTEL and ordered Equatoguinean technicians trained to install and maintain the equipment.

No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026. The software beneath the administration is largely bought in: CNIAPGE signed a licence agreement with Microsoft in June 2015 and works with the Spanish firm Munitecnia to implement the Experta e-government platform (2025). Continuity is thin where it has been examined: the social security institute's head told deputies its database has no replica site and the institute depends on a single internet provider (April 2025). Where the national identity database is hosted, and under whose jurisdiction, had not been published as at September 2026.

The terms on which the December 2025 e-government memorandum with Huawei and the February 2026 agreement with Nigeria's Backbone Connectivity Network, which covers a commercial data centre, govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

On AI the offers are the vendors': Amini's chief executive proposed data infrastructure and sovereign AI capabilities to the Vice-President at Davos in January 2026, and he invited the company to begin a diagnostic in the country. At the Korea-Africa ministerial conference in September 2026 the finance ministry's delegate minister named digital sovereignty among the continent's main strategic challenges and offered the country's energy and digital infrastructure for co-investment.

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